

▶▶ ASSEMBLING THE QUILT LAYERS

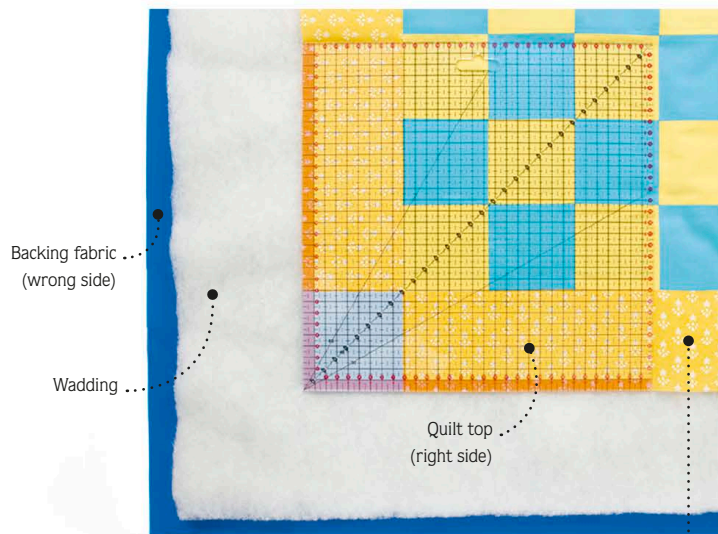
Once you have marked the quilting pattern on the quilt top, it is time to assemble the quilt “sandwich”, which is the layers of top, wadding, and backing that make up

the quilt. If the wadding has been folded, open it out flat and leave it for several hours to relax the wrinkles.



1 Trim the wadding and backing 7.5–15cm (3–6in) larger all around than the finished top. Lay the backing wrong side up on the work surface and smooth it flat. Secure it to the surface with masking tape.

2 Centre the wadding on the backing, and smooth it out.



3 Position the quilt top right side up, centring it on the wadding. Use a ruler to check that the top is squared up. Using large quilter's straight pins, temporarily pin along each squared edge as you work.



4 Working from the centre out diagonally, horizontally, and vertically, tack or pin the layers together. Remove the pins along the edge as you reach them. Keep smoothing the layers. Take tacking stitches 5cm (2in) long – first vertically and horizontally, then diagonally. If pinning using safety pins, follow the same pattern and insert the pins at 7.5–10cm (3–4in) intervals.